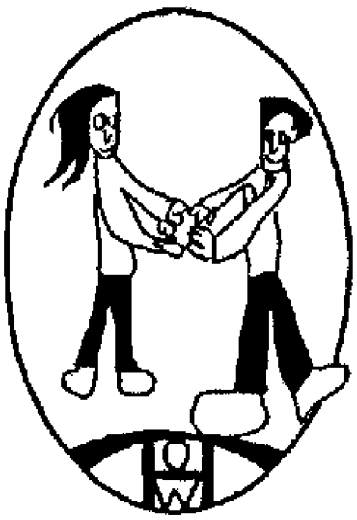
Howbridge Infant School



Mathematics Policy
July 2026

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: July 2025

POLICY NAME - Mathematics **DATE OF REVIEW – July 2026**

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning

For children to:

1. become fluent in the fundamentals of mathematics, including through varied and frequent practice with increasingly complex problems over time, so that pupils develop conceptual understanding and the ability to recall and apply knowledge rapidly and accurately
2. reason mathematically by following a line of enquiry, conjecturing relationships and generalisations, and developing an argument, justification or proof using mathematical language
3. solve problems by applying their mathematics to a variety of routine and non-routine problems with increasing sophistication, including breaking down problems into a series of simpler steps and persevering in seeking solutions
4. master skills through application, discussion, questioning and making connections

- To to apply knowledge of numbers, shape and measures in a variety of ways in all areas of the curriculum
- To gain a solid understanding of number and the value of numbers
- To develop skill and ability in solving number problems in a variety of contexts
- To understand and apply these skills to practical situations
- To develop children's mental maths skills
- To encourage questioning and problem solving
- To provide a strong foundation to enable the children to become confident, numerate learners
- To support the learning and teaching of maths using the outdoor environment
- To link mathematical skills across the curriculum in all key stages

Sources used for the scheme of work

National Curriculum 2014
Foundation Stage Profile 2020
Teacher Assessment Framework for Key Stage 1 (2018-19)
EYFS Statutory Framework 2024
NCETM Mastering Number Program
White Rose Maths

Strategies for teaching

In KS1 each class has a daily maths session of 45-60 minutes which follows the progression of the White Rose Maths scheme, to help us meet the expectations set out from the 2014 National Curriculum. Planning is regularly adapted to meet the national expectations for all children across year groups. Lessons are planned following year group medium term planning however this is often reviewed and adjusted to guarantee it is bespoke to each individual learner and their needs.
All learning is developed through concrete, pictorial and abstract ideas to build on children's skills effectively and progress mathematical comprehension
Practical methods are first used to develop children's base of understanding and create links to previous knowledge. This develops new concepts before providing structure (relational understanding).

Once practical understanding is developed by children, learning will then be progressed through representation of pictures/symbols. This links practical knowledge developed so far to be used, whilst beginning to add structure to ideas.
Learning is progressed to written representations of calculations and problems so that structure to mathematical concepts can be developed.
Once confident and competent children then demonstrate that they have mastered areas of mathematical concepts by applying these within other areas of the curriculum. Children can then also accurately justify and explain their thinking to peers which embeds knowledge and understanding.

Additional daily 10-15 minute mental maths sessions, one of which being arithmetic practise, are used in Foundation Stage and KS1 to develop core understanding of mathematical fundamentals. Problem solving is incorporated into maths planning and is ongoing throughout maths sessions to continually challenge children at a level that is suited to their needs.
Each class is also taught a daily mental maths session supported by the NCETM Maths Hub on Mastering Number.
Parents are regularly updated with their child's progress and ideas are given to promote further learning at home through homework tasks and on year group newsletters. Maths home learning is also set for children to complete at home.
One child per term from each class is chosen to be the terms 'Maths Master' and their achievements and efforts are recognised in our termly Celebration Assemblies. The children each receive a certificate to take home.
Every class has resources to support working out and maths vocabulary for the current topic is displayed around all classrooms to support development of terminology. Each class has a 100 square or large number line displayed for the number range required for their year group determined by the national curriculum to support working methods.

In Early Years classes' maths is taught daily, sometimes as a discrete subject but often combined with other subjects, which are planned in order for children to build skills to meet the Early Learning Goals. In Early Years children are taught discrete number skills through the Mastering Number Program 4 x weekly. This is also used to aid small group work and continuous provision planning. In addition to this Shape, Space and Measure is discreetly taught 1x a week using the White Rose supporting materials.

Every classroom is required to have a Maths working wall display featuring:
- appropriate maths vocabulary words of the week
- 100 square (in KS1) or large number line (in Reception)
- examples of working and methods displaying expected presentation
- examples of children's work showing working outs and methods
-number line

All class teachers use a flipchart in the classroom to demonstrate skills, methods and presentation to the children. This clearly sets out our expectations, and is something that can be referred back to in later lessons. This helps to build on prior learning and link skills together.
Methods and vocabulary are also displayed on the classroom's working wall. This helps children to refer back to previous lessons and is another resource for them to use to aid their independent learning.

A range of resources are used to support learning, which are stored in classrooms and the Year 1 corridor. Practical, computer and interactive resources are used to support development of understanding through practical engagement. These interactive and computer resources are also shared with parents to support the children's maths learning at home.

Across all year groups both daily and weekly maths intervention sessions are implemented to support selected children with basic arithmetic methods, this often includes PPG children. In all year groups Precision Teaching is also used to support children's understanding of mathematical concepts where necessary.

Mastery for Mathematics is planned for in both EYFS and KS1 to enable children to develop a deep understanding of strategies, vocabulary and techniques which underpin mathematical concepts that are applied flexibly and continuously to enrich learning and development. Mastery is planned for at all stages of a lesson and as cross curricular opportunities. Progression of Mastery skills are developed from EYFS to Year 2 to deepen concepts and skills. Mastery is planned for in a variety of accessible ways to enable all children the opportunity to access despite their academic ability. Maths Masters are used within lessons to support learning through explanations, demonstrations and questioning. Maths Mastery is planned to enable children to Build, Challenge, Justify, Apply and Learn in all areas of Mathematics.

Skills are taught and developed using the whole school Calculation policy. Addition, Subtraction, Multiplication and Division methods are divided into each year group to enable progression of skills and methods across the school. *(see Calculation Policy)*

Planning, marking and feedback

School policy is followed as set out in separate documents.
Any member of staff who works with the children during maths sessions is involved in the marking and assessment to support class teacher assessments and to ensure we capture all moments of the child's thinking, learning and progress.

Learning objectives are shown at the top of each piece of work to show the learning to be achieved. These are then highlighted across the week to show whether these objectives have been met.
Regular daily feedback is given through highlighting of work to show when children have met learning objectives and their targets to improve, supporting children's understanding of their learning development. **Pink** – where working/answers has met the learning objectives securely. **Purple** – targets for children to go back and check. **Blue** – challenges to progress learning if the learning objective has been met securely. Children then review learning, targets and challenges to ensure continuation of learning. Verbal feedback is also used to provide timely support and help children understand their next learning steps, shown using a VF sign. Symbols have also been agreed as a staff and shared with children to allow immediate feedback and response to help develop children's understanding and allow rapid progress. These symbols are displayed in class for all to access including staff, children and parents to promote consistency.
Work is also clearly marked with an I (meaning it has been completed independently) or with CT or TA (meaning a class teacher or teaching assistant has supported the child).

Year 2 classes also plan for a 'Marking Station' to be used when appropriate for children to mark their own work before continuing with additional activities. This allows the children to take ownership of their own learning and has made them keen to challenge their own thinking and continue to work to find the correct answer.

Planning is based on the objectives set out in the 2014 Mathematics Curriculum, Teacher Assessment Framework and White Rose Checkpoints. Plans include differentiated activities to challenge all pupils ensuring high expectations for all. Learning objectives are formatted to ensure no learning ceiling is created and all children are aware of the next step in their own learning. Extension activities are planned to challenge all learners. Bloom's Taxonomy questions are included on plans to ensure high order thinking for all learners and development of reasoning and explaining.

Assessment, recording and reporting

Formative and Summative assessments are used throughout the year following school and national guidelines to progress learning effectively.

Written daily assessments are recorded against learning objectives and outcomes by CTs and LSAs. These are ticked to show achievement and next steps are then recorded to continue progression of learning. This informs focussed planning of objectives, resources and activities for the next day to ensure clear progression of learning for all children. In Foundation Stage, The Development Matters statements are continually added to Tapestry observations to create an assessment profile of each individual child which is shared with parents on a daily basis.

As the children work through units, teachers mark objectives in the children's books to show whether they have met the expected standard. We also include the amount of support the child needed to meet the objective. This is then transferred into summative data and inputted on to Sonar Tracker. Progress is then scrutinised by the CT and moderation meetings internally and externally. Intervention plans are then created for children making slow progress. Barriers to learning are thought of, targets created and then activities to meet these targets planned to help children's progress to the next level. Timetables of staff providing additional support are then constantly adapted to provide children with the support they need at that time.

There are statutory assessments at the end of the Foundation Stage and Year 2. These are then reported at the end of the academic year following national expectations. Achievement, progress and next step targets are reported to parents through parent's evenings in October and February, and then in Annual reports in July.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, gifted and talented, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupils' diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals and follow the guidance as set out on page 8 of the 2014 Primary National Curriculum Handbook, including SEN and EAL. All children are taught in the class together and challenged at their own pace accordingly through differentiation of material, resources and approach by adults using Quality First Class Teaching. All needs are planned for following children's Individual Educational Plans and Individual Provision Maps, following the SEN Code of Practice. There are maths intervention groups for children in both Year 1 and 2 to develop fundamental mathematical skills.

Teachers will always be flexible when teaching Maths in order to support children's well-being, mental health, behaviour and sensory needs, making teaching and learning therapeutic e.g. taking learning outside, allowing learners to work on the floor.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

The school manual for budget holders sets out the financial regulations and procedures for the acquisition of resources. Most resources are held in classrooms, with a small central resource for specialist items of low frequency use. All resources are reviewed annually and new items bought on a priority basis, according to the budget for the academic year. New resources can be asked for through a wish list or by email to the Maths coordinators. The Maths coordinators are responsible for checking the quality and range of resources to support the Curriculum as well as keeping track of the budget.
We try to order sustainable resources in line with our Climate Action Policy. Children are taught to only take what they need and be conscious of unnecessary waste and use the correct recycling bin.

Links with other subjects

Opportunities are sought to teach maths across the curriculum and linked to year group topics. Maths is planned to support learning across all areas of the curriculum to develop application of skills and problem solving.

Thinking skills

Using and applying maths allows the children to develop skill in reasoning, questioning, discussing, explaining and thinking creatively to suggest hypotheses and evaluation.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Monitoring takes place through classroom observation, scrutiny of planning, work sampling and discussions with staff and pupils annually by the Maths coordinators. Progress is reviewed by the Maths/Assessment Coordinator each half term during pupil progress meetings to ensure progression for learning across the school and provide action points to develop learning skills further. Progress of children is discussed with CTs and intervention put in place to support. School progress and targets are reported to staff during staff meetings, alongside feedback from pupil questionnaires and work scrutiny.

Staff and school development

These needs are identified through school evaluation, development planning and performance management procedures. The focus for staff development links with the needs identified in the development plan and takes account of the needs of individuals from performance management.
Areas for review and development are identified through group and whole staff discussion. School–led training, including staff/LSA meetings, led by the curriculum coordinators are used to support teacher's and LSA's development and understanding of Mathematics teaching, assessment and learning following courses attended from outside providers when needed/available. Action plans are created and reviewed by the Maths co-ordinator to address school development needs and progress teaching and learning in Maths.

Review

Ellie Willshere, Lucy Stevens
Mathematics Co-ordinators July, 2026
To be reviewed: July 2027